

MANDAR DEODHAR

THE NEXT 100

POLITICS

"He is a dynamic person whose work extends beyond politics and his father's legacy"

AMOL KOLHE
NCP MP

for the foundation's health wing.

Shinde is also planning to make premarital genetic testing free and compulsory, and pulmonary response training mandatory in schools. Equally concerned about the environment, Shinde has launched an initiative to plant several hundred saplings in his constituency to create a mini forest.

His private member's bill on the ban of single-use plastic led to a debate on the subject, and later a ban.

As a two-time MP from Kalyan, Shinde has also lavished attention on his constituency, pushing for rail and infrastructure projects in the area. His initiative to set up a shooting range in Ambernath, only the second public range in the Mumbai Metropolitan Region, resulted in 11 shooters qualifying for selection in the national team this year. He feels he can serve people better as a politician than as a medical practitioner. His constituents would concur. ■

– Kiran D. Tare

MR GREEN FINGERS Shrikant has planted around 10,000 saplings of sandalwood, strawberry, cherry and blueberry in his farm in Satara this year

A SHOT AT POLITICS

She was just 19 when her father, the Gidhaur royal and socialist leader Digvijay Singh, died in June 2010. However, he left her with a love of politics and shooting—Digvijay was a Union minister of state in the Chandra Shekhar (1990–91) and A.B. Vajpayee (1999–2004) governments, and president of the National Rifle Association of India. Mother Putul Singh too is a former MP from Banka. Shreyasi won medals at two successive Commonwealth Games—a silver in 2014, and a gold four years later. She is also an Arjuna awardee.

"Having proved her mettle in sport, she'll do the same in politics"

SUSHIL MODI
Former Deputy CM, Bihar

She seriously started thinking about a career in politics only after she interacted with common people during the first wave of the Covid-19 pandemic in March 2020. That was when she realised that people wanted a young and committed person like her to be their public representative in Jamui. After formally joining BJP in 2020, she contested the Bihar assembly election and trounced the sitting MLA—Vijay Prakash of Rashtriya Janata Dal—in her maiden election by 41,000 votes. ■

– Ashok Priyadarshi

GOLDEN GIRL She's the first person from Bihar to win a Commonwealth gold